

ServiceNow CSM

Complete Beginner's Guide

Customer Service Management — Explained Simply

+ 30 Scenario-Based Interview Questions

For Beginners

Scripting Included

Interview Ready

Real Scenarios

This guide covers everything about CSM in ServiceNow — written in plain, simple English so anyone can understand it. Whether you are preparing for an interview or just starting out with ServiceNow CSM, this guide is for you.

Table of Contents

1. [What is ServiceNow CSM?](#)
2. [Key CSM Modules & Tables](#)
3. [CSM Lifecycle — Step by Step](#)
4. [Important CSM Concepts](#)
5. [CSM Roles & Who Does What](#)
6. [CSM Configuration Basics](#)
7. [CSM Scripting Essentials](#)
8. [30 Interview Q&A; — CSM & Scripting](#)

1. What is ServiceNow CSM?

Think of CSM like a super-smart help desk for companies that deal with customers — not just internal employees. CSM stands for **Customer Service Management**. It is a module inside ServiceNow that helps companies manage all the problems, questions, and requests that come from their external customers.

Simple Real-Life Example:

Imagine you bought a phone from a company and it stopped working. You call their support line. On the other side, the support agent opens ServiceNow CSM, creates a case for your issue, tracks the repair, and keeps you updated. That whole process is CSM.

Why is CSM different from ITSM (IT Service Management)?

Feature	ITSM (IT)	CSM (Customer Service)
Who uses it?	Internal employees / IT staff	External customers / clients
Main record	Incident / Request	Case
Goal	Fix IT problems	Satisfy customers
Portal	Employee Self-Service (ESS)	Customer Self-Service (CSS)
SLA focus	Internal response times	Customer satisfaction (CSAT)

Key Benefit of CSM:

- Handle customer issues faster
- Connect customer cases to back-office work (field service, orders, etc.)
- Give customers a self-service portal so they can help themselves
- Measure customer happiness with CSAT surveys
- Route cases automatically to the right team

2. Key CSM Modules & Tables

ServiceNow CSM is made up of several modules. Think of modules as different rooms in a house — each room has a specific purpose. Below are the most important ones you need to know.

Core CSM Modules:

Module	Table Name	What It Does (Plain English)
Cases	sn_customerservice_case	The main record in CSM. Every customer issue = one case.
Accounts	customer_account	Represents the company or business that is your customer.
Contacts	customer_contact	The individual person at that company who raised the case.
Consumer (B2C)	csn_consumer	Used when your customer is an individual person, not a company.
Products	cmdb_model	The product or service the customer has bought. Cases are often about a problem with a product.
Entitlements	sn_entitlement_entitlement	Defines what support a customer is allowed to receive based on their contract.
Service Contracts	ast_contract	The agreement between your company and the customer about service levels.
CSM Portal	N/A (Service Portal framework)	The website where customers can log in, raise cases, and view their history.
Customer Communities	sn_cd_community_post	A forum where customers can post questions and help each other.
Surveys / CSAT	asmt_assessment_instance	Sends a satisfaction survey to the customer after a case is closed.

Important tip: The most important table you will work with daily is **sn_customerservice_case**. Whenever you write scripts, business rules, or workflows for CSM — this is the table you target.

3. CSM Case Lifecycle — Step by Step

A Case in CSM goes through several stages from when it is first created to when it is finally resolved. This is called the **Case Lifecycle**. Understanding this is very important for both interviews and real work.

Stage	State Name	What Happens
Step 1	New	A customer contacts support or submits via portal. A
Step 2	Open / Assigned	An agent picks up the case and it moves to 'Open'. A
Step 3	Work in Progress	Agent is actively investigating or fixing the issue.
Step 4	Pending (Optional)	Waiting for something — customer response, a part, A
Step 5	Resolved	The issue is fixed! Agent marks the case as Resolved
Step 6	Closed	After a set number of days (or when customer confirm

State Values in Code:

In ServiceNow, states are stored as numbers. Here are the common ones for Cases:

State Number	State Label
1	New
2	Open
3	Pending
4	Awaiting Info
6	Resolved
7	Closed
8	Cancelled

SLA (Service Level Agreement) and Lifecycle:

SLAs define how fast a case must be responded to and resolved. For example: *'All P1 cases must be responded to within 1 hour and resolved within 4 hours.'* If the SLA is about to breach (miss the deadline), ServiceNow shows a warning. This is very important in CSM because customer happiness depends on it.

4. Important CSM Concepts

Case Routing / Assignment Rules

ServiceNow can automatically assign a case to the right team or agent based on rules you configure. For example: 'If product = Router AND priority = High, assign to Network Support team.' This is done through Assignment Rules or Queues.

Major Case Management

When many customers are affected by the same problem (e.g., server outage), you create one 'Major Case' and link all smaller cases to it. This is similar to Problem Management in ITSM.

Case Escalation

If a case is not resolved in time or the customer is very angry, it gets 'escalated' — sent to a senior agent or manager. This can be automated with escalation rules.

Customer Self-Service Portal (CSS)

A website where customers can: submit new cases, check status, search a knowledge base, and chat with an agent. Built using ServiceNow Service Portal framework.

Entitlements

Not every customer gets the same level of support. Entitlements are like a 'support subscription'. A premium customer may get 24/7 support; a basic customer may only get business hours support. ServiceNow checks entitlements before letting a customer submit a high-priority case.

Agent Workspace

A special view in ServiceNow for CSM agents — it shows all their cases, customer history, and a chat panel all in one screen. It is faster than the classic ServiceNow interface.

CSAT (Customer Satisfaction)

After a case closes, an automatic survey is sent to the customer. They rate the service (e.g., 1-5 stars). This score is called CSAT and is a key metric for measuring team performance.

Knowledge Base in CSM

Agents can create articles explaining how to fix common problems. Customers can search these articles in the portal to solve issues themselves — reducing the number of cases raised.

Communities

A customer discussion forum inside the CSM portal. Customers ask questions and other customers or agents answer them. Like a public forum, but inside your support portal.

5. CSM Roles — Who Does What?

ServiceNow CSM has specific roles. A 'role' controls what a user can see and do. Here are the main roles you need to know:

Role Name	Role ID	What They Can Do
CSM Agent	sn_customerservice_agent	View and update cases, communicate with customers
CSM Manager	sn_customerservice_manager	Everything agent can do + configure queues, view rep
CSM Admin	sn_customerservice.admin	Full admin rights for CSM module
Customer (Portal User)	sn_customerservice.customer	Submit and view their own cases via portal
Customer Admin	sn_customerservice.customer_admin	Manage their company's cases and users in portal
CSM Approver	sn_customerservice.approver	Approve certain types of customer requests

Interview Tip: Interviewers often ask — 'What is the difference between a Customer and a Customer Admin?' Answer: A Customer can only see their own cases. A Customer Admin can see ALL cases raised by their company and can manage other users from their company on the portal.

6. CSM Configuration Basics

This section explains the most commonly configured areas in CSM. As a developer or admin, you will regularly work on these.

6.1 Queues

A Queue is like a waiting room for cases. Cases come in and are assigned to a queue based on rules. For example: 'All cases about Billing go to the Billing Queue.' Agents monitor queues and pick up cases from them. You configure queues under: *Customer Service > Administration > Queues*.

6.2 Routing Rules

Routing Rules are conditions that automatically move a case to the correct queue or assign it to an agent. Example: *IF Case Category = 'Network' AND Priority = 1, THEN assign to Network Team Queue*.

6.3 Case Templates

Templates are pre-filled forms. When an agent creates a case, they can pick a template that automatically fills in common fields — saving time and reducing errors.

6.4 Email Notifications

ServiceNow automatically sends emails to customers when: a case is created, the state changes, or an agent adds a comment. You configure these under: *System Notification > Notifications*.

6.5 SLA Definitions

You define SLAs based on priority. Go to: *Customer Service > Administration > SLA Definitions*. For each SLA, you set: the condition (when it starts), the duration, pause conditions, and what happens when it is about to breach.

6.6 Approval Processes

Some case types need approval before work starts. For example, a refund case might need a manager's approval. You can configure this using Approval Rules in the CSM module.

7. CSM Scripting Essentials

Scripting in ServiceNow uses JavaScript. You write scripts to automate things — like updating fields, sending notifications, or validating data. Here are the most important scripting concepts for CSM.

7.1 GlideRecord — The Most Important Object

GlideRecord is how you read and write data in ServiceNow database tables. Think of it as a pointer that moves through records in a table.

```
var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
gr.addQuery('state', 1); // state = New
gr.query();
while (gr.next()) {
    gs.info('Case: ' + gr.number + ' | Customer: ' + gr.account.getDisplayValue());
}
```

7.2 Business Rules

A Business Rule runs server-side JavaScript when a record is inserted, updated, deleted, or queried. For CSM, you often use Business Rules on the Case table to automate actions.

When	What it means
Before	Script runs BEFORE the record saves to the database. Use to validate or
After	Script runs AFTER the record saves. Use to trigger notifications or update
Async	Script runs in background. Use for heavy operations that don't need to be
Display	Script runs when the form loads. Used to pre-populate UI.

7.3 Client Scripts

Client Scripts run in the user's browser (client side). They react to form events — like when a field changes or when the form loads.

```
// Example: Show alert when priority is Critical
function onChange(control, oldValue, newValue, isLoading) {
    if (newValue == '1') { // 1 = Critical
        alert('This case is Critical! Please escalate immediately.');
```

7.4 Script Includes

Script Includes are reusable functions/libraries stored in ServiceNow. Instead of writing the same code in multiple places, you write it once in a Script Include and call it from anywhere.

```
// Script Include: CSMUtils
var CSMUtils = Class.create();
CSMUtils.prototype = {
```

```
initialize: function() {},
getCasesByAccount: function(accountSysId) {
    var cases = [];
    var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
    gr.addQuery('account', accountSysId);
    gr.query();
    while (gr.next()) { cases.push(gr.number+''); }
    return cases;
},
type: 'CSMUtils'
};
```

7.5 Flow Designer & Subflows

Flow Designer is a no-code/low-code tool for automating processes visually. For CSM, you can create flows like: 'When a case is created with Priority = Critical, send SMS to the on-call manager and create a task.' Subflows are reusable flows that can be called from other flows — like a function in programming.

7.6 ACLs (Access Control Lists)

ACLs control who can read, write, create, or delete records. In CSM, you must be careful with ACLs because customers should ONLY see their own cases — never other customers' cases. ACLs are evaluated using: Table name + Operation + Condition + Script.

8. 30 Interview Questions — CSM & Scripting

These are 30 real scenario-based questions you might face in a ServiceNow CSM interview. Each answer is written in simple English. Read them carefully — understanding the WHY is more important than memorizing the exact words.

Part A — CSM Concept Questions (Q1–Q12)

Q 1 A customer calls in saying they cannot log in to your portal. How would you set up the process to handle this in ServiceNow CSM?

Answer:

This is a classic case creation scenario. Here is what you would do:

1. The customer contacts support (phone, email, or portal). A **Case** is created on the table **sn_customerservice_case**.
2. The case is linked to the customer's **Contact** record and their **Account** (company).
3. A **Routing Rule** automatically assigns it to the 'Portal Support' queue.
4. An agent picks it up, works on it, and updates the case with comments.
5. When resolved, the case state is set to 'Resolved' and a notification email is sent to the customer.
6. After a set number of days, the case auto-closes and a **CSAT survey** is sent.

Q 2 What is the difference between a Contact and a Consumer in ServiceNow CSM?

Answer:

Contact is used in B2B (Business-to-Business) scenarios. A Contact is a person who works at a customer company (Account). Example: John is a Contact who works at Acme Corp.

Consumer is used in B2C (Business-to-Consumer) scenarios. A Consumer is an individual customer — not linked to a business. Example: John is just a regular person who bought a product from your website.

The table for Contact is **customer_contact** and for Consumer it is **csm_consumer**.

Interview Tip: Always mention B2B vs B2C — interviewers love this distinction.

Q 3 Explain Entitlements in CSM. Give a real-world example.

Answer:

An **Entitlement** is a permission or right that a customer has to receive a certain level of support, based on what they paid for.

Real-world example: Say a customer bought a 'Gold Support Plan'. Their entitlement says: 24/7 support, P1 cases resolved in 4 hours, maximum 50 cases per year.

When this customer submits a case, ServiceNow checks their entitlement automatically. If they have used all 50 cases, the system can block new cases or warn the agent.

Entitlements link to **Service Contracts** (the actual agreement document) and to **Products/Assets** (what product the support covers).

Q 4 What is a Major Case? When would you use it?

Answer:

A **Major Case** is a special case created when a single issue is affecting many customers at the same time.

Example: Your company's website is down and 500 customers are calling about it. Instead of creating 500 separate cases, you create ONE Major Case. All 500 individual cases are then linked to that Major Case.

Benefits: Agents can send one bulk communication to all affected customers. You fix the root cause once. Reporting is cleaner.

It is similar to the **Problem** concept in ITSM — find the root cause, fix it, and link all related incidents/cases to it.

Q 5 A customer says they are not receiving email notifications when their case is updated. How do you troubleshoot this?

Answer:

Great troubleshooting scenario! Here are the steps:

1. Go to **System Logs > Emails** — check if emails were sent and if there were any errors.
2. Check the customer's Contact record — is the email address correct? Is 'Subscribe to email' checked?
3. Go to **System Notification > Notifications** — find the notification for case updates. Is it active? Does the condition match?
4. Check if the notification has the correct recipient. Is it set to 'Opened by' or 'Caller' — and does that match the contact?
5. Check if the customer's email was marked as spam or bounced.
6. Check **User Preferences** — the user might have opted out of notifications.

Q 6 What is the Customer Service Portal and how is it different from the Employee Self-Service Portal?

Answer:

The **Customer Service Portal (CSS Portal)** is for external customers. Customers log in here to submit cases, track status, search knowledge articles, and chat with agents — all without calling support.

The **Employee Self-Service (ESS) Portal** is for internal employees. They use it to raise IT requests, report incidents, or request HR services.

Key differences: CSS Portal is accessible from the internet (public). ESS Portal is for company employees only. CSS Portal uses CSM module data. ESS Portal uses ITSM module data.

Both are built on ServiceNow's **Service Portal** framework using widgets, pages, and portals configured in **Service Portal > Portals**.

Q 7 What is CSAT and how does it work in ServiceNow CSM?

Answer:

CSAT stands for Customer Satisfaction Score. It measures how happy a customer was with the service they received.

How it works: When a case is closed (or resolved), ServiceNow automatically sends a survey email to the customer. The survey asks them to rate their experience (usually 1-5 stars or 1-10 scale).

The responses are stored in the **Assessments** module. Managers can then view average CSAT scores per agent, team, or time period.

In code, CSAT is connected to the **asmt_assessment_instance** table and is triggered by a **Notification** or **Flow** when the case state changes to Closed.

Q 8 How does Case Assignment work in CSM? What are the different methods?

Answer:

Cases can be assigned in 4 main ways:

1. **Manual Assignment:** An agent or supervisor manually picks an agent from the 'Assigned to' field.
2. **Assignment Rules:** Conditions that automatically set the assigned group or agent when a case is created/updated. Example: If category = Billing, assign to Billing Team.
3. **Queues:** Cases go into a queue. Agents in that queue see all unassigned cases and pick them up.
4. **Round Robin (via Script or Flow):** Cases are distributed equally among agents in a group — one by one in rotation.

Best practice: Use Queues + Assignment Rules for large teams. Use manual assignment only for escalations.

Q 9 A new type of customer issue is very common and agents waste time entering the same data repeatedly. How would you solve this in CSM?

Answer:

The answer is **Case Templates!**

A Case Template pre-fills common fields so agents don't have to type them every time. For example, a template for 'Password Reset' could pre-fill: Category = Access Management, Priority = Medium, Assignment Group = IT Support.

How to create: Go to **Customer Service > Configuration > Case Templates**. Create a template, fill in the default values.

When an agent creates a case, they select the template from a dropdown and all fields are auto-populated. The agent just needs to fill in the customer-specific details.

This saves time, reduces errors, and ensures consistency.

Q What is the difference between a Case and a Task in CSM?

1
0

Answer:

A **Case** is the main customer-facing record. It represents the customer's issue from start to finish. The customer can see it in the portal.

A **Task** (specifically a CSM Task or `sn_customerservice_task`) is a piece of internal work that needs to be done to resolve the case. The customer usually does NOT see tasks.

Example: A customer raises a Case about a faulty router. To fix it, the support team creates 3 Tasks: (1) Diagnose the issue, (2) Ship a replacement, (3) Call the customer to confirm. All 3 tasks are linked to the original Case.

Cases live in `sn_customerservice_case`. Tasks live in `sn_customerservice_task`.

Q How would you configure an SLA for CSM cases with different priorities?

1
1

Answer:

Go to **Customer Service > Administration > SLA Definitions** (or search for it).

For each priority level, create a separate SLA Definition:

Priority 1 (Critical): Response = 1 hour, Resolution = 4 hours

Priority 2 (High): Response = 4 hours, Resolution = 8 hours

Priority 3 (Medium): Response = 8 hours, Resolution = 2 days

For each SLA, set: Table = `sn_customerservice_case` | Condition = `priority=1` | Start Condition = Case created | Pause condition = `state=3` (Pending) | Breach action = Send notification to manager.

Important: SLAs pause when the case state is 'Pending' (waiting for customer) so the timer does not count unfairly.

Q What is Agent Workspace in CSM? Why is it better than the classic interface?

1
2

Answer:

Agent Workspace is a modern, purpose-built interface for CSM agents. It shows everything an agent needs in one screen: case details, customer history, live chat, related cases, and knowledge articles — all side by side.

Classic interface shows one form at a time. Agent Workspace shows multiple panels simultaneously.

Benefits: Faster case handling. Less switching between tabs. Real-time updates. Built-in messaging. Customer 360 view (see all past cases, products, contacts for the customer in one click).

Access it at: **/csm_agent_workspace** or via Customer Service > Agent Workspace.

Part B — Scripting Scenario Questions (Q13–Q30)

Q 13 Write a Business Rule to automatically set the Priority to 'High' when a Case is created with the Category 'Network Outage'.

Answer:

Table: sn_customerservice_case | When: Before | Operation: Insert

```
// Business Rule Script (Before - Insert)
if (current.category == 'network_outage') {
    current.priority = 2; // 2 = High
}
```

Explanation: 'current' refers to the case being created right now. We check if the category equals 'network_outage' and if so, we set priority to 2 (High). Since this is a Before rule, the change is saved automatically when the record inserts.

Q 14 Write a script to find all Open cases for a specific Account and print their numbers.

Answer:

This uses GlideRecord to query the case table:

```
var accountSysId = '<paste_account_sys_id_here>';
var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
gr.addQuery('account', accountSysId);
gr.addQuery('state', 2); // 2 = Open
gr.query();
while (gr.next()) {
    gs.info('Case Number: ' + gr.number);
}
```

Key points: Always use gr.query() before gr.next(). The while loop iterates through each matching record. gs.info() prints to the system log — use it for debugging.

Q 15 A Client Script should warn the agent if they try to set a case priority to Critical (1) without filling in the 'Short Description'. How would you write this?

Answer:

This is an onChange Client Script on the Priority field:

```
// Client Script: onChange | Table: sn_customerservice_case | Field: priority
function onChange(control, oldValue, newValue, isLoading) {
    if (isLoading) return; // Don't run on form load
    if (newValue == '1') { // Critical
        var shortDesc = g_form.getValue('short_description');
        if (!shortDesc || shortDesc.trim() == '') {
            alert('Warning: Critical cases require a Short Description!');
            g_form.setValue('priority', oldValue); // Reset to old value
        }
    }
}
```

g_form is the client-side object for interacting with the form. **g_form.getValue()** reads a field value. **g_form.setValue()** changes a field value.

Q How do you prevent a case from being saved if the 'Contact' field is empty? Write the code.
1
6

Answer:

Use a UI Policy or a Before Business Rule with validation:

```
// Business Rule: Before - Insert/Update
// Table: sn_customerservice_case
if (!current.contact) {
    current.setAbortAction(true);
    gs.addErrorMessage('Contact is required. Please select a contact before saving.');
```

current.setAbortAction(true) stops the save. **gs.addErrorMessage()** shows a red error message at the top of the form to the user.

Alternatively, you can use a UI Policy to make the field mandatory — no scripting needed. But Business Rules are more reliable for complex conditions.

Q Write a Script Include that returns the total number of Open cases for a given Account.
1
7

Answer:

```
var CaseCounter = Class.create();
CaseCounter.prototype = {
  initialize: function() {},

  getOpenCaseCount: function(accountSysId) {
    var ga = new GlideAggregate('sn_customerservice_case');
    ga.addQuery('account', accountSysId);
    ga.addQuery('state', 'IN', '1,2'); // New and Open
    ga.addAggregate('COUNT');
    ga.query();
    if (ga.next()) {
      return ga.getAggregate('COUNT');
    }
    return 0;
  },
  type: 'CaseCounter'
};
```

GlideAggregate is used for COUNT, SUM, AVG queries — much faster than looping through GlideRecord. Always use it when you only need a count.

Q Write an After Business Rule to send an email notification to the assigned agent when a Case is escalated (priority changes to 1 - Critical).
1
8

Answer:

Table: sn_customerservice_case | When: After | Condition: priority changes to 1

```
// Condition on BR: current.priority == 1 && current.priority.changes()
var notif = new GlideRecord('sys_email');
var agent = new GlideRecord('sys_user');
if (agent.get(current.assigned_to)) {
  var emailBody = 'Case ' + current.number + ' has been escalated to CRITICAL.';
  emailBody += ' Please take immediate action.';
  gs.eventQueue('case.escalated', current, agent.email, current.number);
}
```

Better approach: Use **gs.eventQueue()** with a registered Event and Notification — this is the proper ServiceNow way. The event triggers the notification which sends the email. Avoid direct email sending from scripts.

Q How would you query cases created in the last 7 days using GlideRecord?
1
9

Answer:

```
var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
var sevenDaysAgo = new GlideDateTime();
sevenDaysAgo.addDaysUTC(-7);
gr.addQuery('sys_created_on', '>=', sevenDaysAgo);
gr.query();
while (gr.next()) {
    gs.info(gr.number + ' created on ' + gr.sys_created_on);
}
```

GlideDateTime is used for date/time operations. **addDaysUTC(-7)** subtracts 7 days from now. Always use **GlideDateTime** for date math — don't manipulate date strings manually.

Q What is the difference between **gs.info()**, **gs.warn()**, and **gs.error()** in ServiceNow?
2
0

Answer:

All three write messages to the **System Log (syslog table)**, but at different severity levels:

gs.info('message') — For general information. Log level = Info. Use for debugging or tracking flow.

gs.warn('message') — For warnings. Something unexpected happened but the process can continue. Log level = Warning.

gs.error('message') — For serious errors. Something went wrong that needs attention. Log level = Error.

You can view logs at: **System Diagnostics > System Log > All**. Filter by type to find your messages.

Interview Tip: Never leave **gs.info()** or **gs.log()** calls in production code — they slow down the system and clutter the logs.

Q Write a script to bulk-update all 'Pending' cases that have been pending for more than 5 days to 'Open'.
2
1

Answer:

```
var fiveDaysAgo = new GlideDateTime();
fiveDaysAgo.addDaysUTC(-5);

var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
gr.addQuery('state', 3); // 3 = Pending
gr.addQuery('sys_updated_on', '<=', fiveDaysAgo);
gr.query();
while (gr.next()) {
    gr.state = 2; // Set to Open
    gr.work_notes = 'Auto-reopened: pending for more than 5 days.';
    gr.update();
}
```

gr.update() saves each record inside the loop. This is called a bulk update. For very large datasets (1000+ records), consider using **GlideUpdateSet** or batching to avoid timeouts.

Q 2 2 How do you use 'current' and 'previous' in a Business Rule? Give an example relevant to CSM.

Answer:

current refers to the current state of the record AFTER the change.

previous refers to the state of the record BEFORE the change.

```
// Check if the assigned agent changed
if (current.assigned_to != previous.assigned_to) {
    gs.info('Case ' + current.number + ' was reassigned.');
```

```
    gs.info('Old agent: ' + previous.assigned_to.getDisplayValue());
    gs.info('New agent: ' + current.assigned_to.getDisplayValue());
}
```

Important: 'previous' is only available in AFTER Business Rules, not Before rules. In Before rules, use **current.fieldname.changesFrom(value)** instead.

Q 2 3 A Flow Designer flow needs to create a CSM Task when a case priority is set to Critical. Walk through how you would build this.

Answer:

In Flow Designer (**Flow Designer > New Flow**):

1. **Trigger:** Record Updated | Table: sn_customerservice_case | Condition: Priority changes to Critical (1)
2. **Action 1:** Create Record | Table: sn_customerservice_task | Set fields: Parent Case = trigger record, Short Description = 'Critical case — immediate action required', Priority = 1, Assigned Group = [relevant group]
3. **Action 2:** Send Email | To: assigned_to of the case | Subject: CRITICAL case escalation | Body: Dynamic content using data pills from the trigger record
4. Save and Activate the flow.

Data Pills are the drag-and-drop variables in Flow Designer that reference field values from trigger records. No scripting needed for this scenario!

Q 2 4 How would you write an ACL to ensure customers can only read their own cases and not other customers' cases?

Answer:

Go to **Security > Access Control (ACL)**. Create a new ACL:

Type: Record | Operation: Read | Table: sn_customerservice_case

```
// ACL Condition Script
// Only allow if the logged-in user's contact record matches the case's contact
var userId = gs.getUserID();
var contact = new GlideRecord('customer_contact');
contact.addQuery('user', userId);
contact.query();
if (contact.next()) {
    answer = (current.contact == contact.sys_id);
} else {
    answer = false;
}
```

answer is the special variable in ACL scripts — set it to true to ALLOW access or false to DENY. This script allows access only if the case's contact matches the logged-in user's contact record.

Q What is GlideAjax and how would you use it in a CSM context? Give a code
2 example.
5

Answer:

GlideAjax allows Client Scripts to call a Script Include on the SERVER side without refreshing the page. It is the bridge between client and server.

Use case: When an agent selects a Customer Account, automatically fetch and display the number of open cases for that account — without a page reload.

```
// Client Script (onChange on 'account' field)
function onChange(control, oldValue, newValue, isLoading) {
    if (isLoading || !newValue) return;
    var ga = new GlideAjax('CaseCounter');
    ga.addParam('sysparm_name', 'getOpenCaseCount');
    ga.addParam('sysparm_account', newValue);
    ga.getXMLAnswer(function(answer) {
        g_form.setValue('description',
            'Open cases for this account: ' + answer);
    });
}
```

The Script Include (CaseCounter) must have **Client callable: true** checked, and the function must return the value using **return** (not gs.info).

Q Explain the difference between addQuery and addEncodedQuery in GlideRecord.
2 When would you use each?
6

Answer:

addQuery(field, operator, value) — Used when you know the field name and value at code time. Clean, readable, and recommended for most cases.

```
gr.addQuery('priority', 1);  
gr.addQuery('state', 'IN', '1,2,3');
```

addEncodedQuery(encodedQueryString) — Used when you have a pre-built query string (e.g., from a URL filter or user-defined filter). Less readable but flexible.

```
gr.addEncodedQuery('priority=1^state=2^accountISNOTEMPTY');
```

When to use encoded query: When you copy a filter string directly from ServiceNow's URL bar. When the query string is stored in a field or passed as a parameter. When the query is too complex to build with multiple addQuery calls.

Q 2 7 A customer submits a case via the portal but the form does not show the 'Product' field. How would you make the Product field visible only when the user is a Customer (portal user)?

Answer:

This involves **UI Policy** (or **Client Script**) with a role check — but since portal users don't run standard UI Policies the same way, the best approach is to use a **Service Portal Widget** or **Service Portal Page configuration**.

For the standard form in the backend, use a UI Policy:

Condition: **gs.hasRole('sn_customerservice.customer')** (in a script-based condition)

Action: Show field 'Product'

For a Service Portal form: Edit the widget or use a Catalog Item variable condition to show/hide the product field based on the user role using:

```
// In a catalog item variable condition (server script)  
if (gs.hasRole('sn_customerservice.customer')) {  
    return true; // Show the field  
}  
return false;
```

Q 2 8 How do you update a reference field in a record using GlideRecord? For example, setting the Contact on a Case.

Answer:

Reference fields store the **sys_id** of the referenced record — not the display name. So you must set the sys_id:

```
var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
if (gr.get('CS0001234')) { // Get case by number? No – get by sys_id
    gr.contact = '<sys_id_of_contact>';
    gr.update();
}
```

To get a case by number (not sys_id):

```
var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
gr.addQuery('number', 'CS0001234');
gr.query();
if (gr.next()) {
    gr.contact = contactSysId;
    gr.update();
}
```

Common mistake: Setting a reference field to the display value (e.g., 'John Smith') instead of the sys_id. This will fail silently or cause errors.

Q 29 Write a Scheduled Script (Scheduled Job) that auto-closes all Resolved cases older than 5 days.

Answer:

Go to **System Scheduler > Scheduled Jobs > New**. Set run time (e.g., daily at 2 AM). Add this script:

```
// Auto-close Resolved cases older than 5 days
var cutoffDate = new GlideDateTime();
cutoffDate.addDaysUTC(-5);

var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
gr.addQuery('state', 6); // 6 = Resolved
gr.addQuery('resolved_at', '<=', cutoffDate);
gr.query();

var count = 0;
while (gr.next()) {
    gr.state = 7; // 7 = Closed
    gr.close_notes = 'Auto-closed after 5 days of resolution.';
    gr.update();
    count++;
}
gs.info('Auto-closed ' + count + ' cases.');
```

Interview Tip: Always add a gs.info at the end to log how many records were processed. This helps with auditing and debugging.

Q
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You need to create a REST API endpoint in ServiceNow that returns all open CSM cases for a given account. How would you approach this?

Answer:

Use a **Scripted REST API** in ServiceNow:

Go to: **System Web Services > Scripted REST APIs > New**

Create API: Name = 'CSM Case API' | API ID = csm_case_api

Add Resource: Method = GET | Relative Path = /open-cases/{accountId}

```
// Scripted REST API Resource Script
(function process(request, response) {
    var accountId = request.pathParams.accountId;
    var cases = [];

    var gr = new GlideRecord('sn_customerservice_case');
    gr.addQuery('account', accountId);
    gr.addQuery('state', 'IN', '1,2'); // New, Open
    gr.query();

    while (gr.next()) {
        cases.push({
            number: gr.getValue('number'),
            subject: gr.getValue('short_description'),
            priority: gr.priority.getDisplayValue(),
            state: gr.state.getDisplayValue()
        });
    }
    response.setBody({ cases: cases, count: cases.length });
})(request, response);
```

The API will be available at: **[https://your-instance.service-now.com/api/\[namespace\]/csm_case_api/open-cases/{accountId}](https://your-instance.service-now.com/api/[namespace]/csm_case_api/open-cases/{accountId})**

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet

Most Important Tables in CSM:

Table	Purpose
sn_customerservice_case	Main Case table — the heart of CSM
sn_customerservice_task	Tasks linked to cases
customer_account	Customer company/account
customer_contact	Individual person at the customer company
csm_consumer	Individual consumer (B2C)
sn_entitlement_entitlement	Customer entitlements/support rights
ast_contract	Service contracts

Key Scripting Objects:

Object	Where it runs	Use it for
current	Server (Business Rule)	The record being saved right now
previous	Server (After BR only)	The record before changes
g_form	Client (Client Script)	Interact with the form — get/set values
GlideRecord	Server	Query and update database tables
GlideAggregate	Server	COUNT, SUM, AVG queries
GlideDateTime	Server	Date and time math
GlideAjax	Client (calls server)	Call Script Include from Client Script
gs	Server	System-level functions: gs.info(), gs.getUserID()

Case State Numbers:

Number	State
1	New
2	Open
3	Pending
4	Awaiting Info

6	Resolved
7	Closed
8	Cancelled

Final Interview Tips: Always mention the TABLE NAME when discussing records (not just 'the case table'). Show you understand WHEN to use Business Rules vs Client Scripts vs Flow Designer. Mention CSAT, SLA, and Entitlements — these show you understand CSM's business purpose, not just the technical side. Practice speaking about cases from the CUSTOMER's perspective, not just the admin's.